

Minimum Features of a CRM

A CRM (Customer Relationship Management system) can be very simple and still provide value. The minimum viable CRM typically needs to help answer three questions:

1. Who are my customers and prospects?
2. What interactions have I had with them?
3. What should happen next?

Core CRM Features

1. Contact Management

Store and organize information about people and companies: Name, Company, Email, Phone, Job title, Notes, Tags or categories.

2. Company/Account Records

Track organizations separately from individual contacts: Company details, Industry, Website, Associated contacts.

3. Activity History

Keep a timeline of interactions: Calls, Emails, Meetings, Notes, Tasks completed.

4. Lead & Opportunity Tracking

Track potential sales: Lead source, Status, Estimated value, Expected close date.

5. Task & Follow-Up Management

Reminders, Due dates, Follow-up tasks, Assignments to team members.

6. Basic Search & Filtering

Search by name, company, email, etc.; Filter by status, owner, tags, dates.

7. User Management

User accounts, Ownership of contacts/opportunities, Basic permissions.

8. Reporting Dashboard

Number of leads, Open opportunities, Won/lost deals, Upcoming tasks.

Nice-to-Have Features (Not Minimum)

Email integration, Calendar sync, Marketing automation, Workflow automation, Document storage, Quotes and invoicing, Customer support ticketing, AI assistance, Mobile app.

Minimum Database Model

Contacts – People you're tracking

Accounts – Companies/organizations

Opportunities – Potential deals

Activities – Calls, emails, meetings, notes

Tasks – Follow-ups and reminders

Users – CRM users